
PROTOCOL

1. **Photograph the plates twice** — under **blue-light transillumination** and under **ambient light**. Save both. Once you have picked, these are the only record of what the colonies looked like.
2. **Tubes or a block**. Up to **4 cultures**: individual snap-cap culture tubes. More than that: a **24-well block**.
3. **Label**. Tubes: the clone ID on each tube. Block: the labels go on the **airpore sheet**, not the block — the wells are identified by position.
4. Fill each tube or well with **4 mL 2YT + antibiotic** — the one on your labsheet. **It is not always carb**.
5. Pick **4 colonies from each plate**: touch a sterile toothpick to a single colony and drop it in. It stays there.
 - **Into a block, pick in labsheet order, left to right**. The layout has to match the data-entry layout — if it does not, nothing errors, the results are just silently scrambled. Into labelled tubes it does not matter; the label travels with the culture.
 - **Well-isolated colonies only**. Never a small one beside a big one; that is a satellite and usually has no plasmid.
 - **Do not pick by brightness**. Choosing the brightest and then correlating against a prediction is circular.
6. **Cover**. Tubes: caps on loosely, so they can breathe. Block: the airpore sheet.
7. Grow in the **shaking incubator, 16–36 h**. Into the fridge by **36 h** — past that they overgrow.
8. **Parafilm the plates** and store them **upside-down in the fridge** — you may need to go back to them.
 - Note why you picked each one (“very green, slow growing”).